Tractor



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 7 labs

Covers these lab items: Tractor

What it is used for

A tractor provides power for agricultural tasks such as tilling, towing, and operating mounted implements. Correct inspection, trained driving, and safe attachment handling help prevent collisions, rollovers, and mechanical injury.

Main parts

- Engine produces the power needed to move the tractor and operate implements.
- Transmission and clutch transfer power to the drive wheels.
- Steering system controls the direction of travel.
- Service brakes and parking brake control stopping and stationary holding.
- Power take-off shaft drives compatible powered implements.
- Three-point linkage or hitch connects mounted or towed implements.
- Operator seat, controls, and protective structure support safe operation.

Before you start

1. Only a trained and authorised operator should drive the tractor.
2. Read the operator's manual and complete the required pre-use inspection.
3. Check tyres, wheels, brakes, steering, lights, horn, mirrors, and safety guards.
4. Check engine oil, coolant, fuel, and other fluids according to the manual.
5. Inspect hitch points, linkage, power take-off cover, and attached implements.
6. Adjust the seat and mirrors, wear the seat belt where fitted, and clear the route.

How to use

1. Mount the tractor using the designated steps and maintain three points of contact.
2. Adjust the seat and confirm the controls are within safe reach.
3. Start the engine according to the manual and check the instrument indicators.
4. Test the brakes, steering, lights, and horn in a safe open area.
5. Select the correct gear and move off slowly after checking the surroundings.
6. Operate at a suitable speed for the terrain, load, and attached implement.
7. Use the approved procedure when connecting or disconnecting implements and isolate power before adjustments.
8. Disengage the power take-off before approaching or servicing an attached implement.
9. Park on firm, level ground, lower implements, apply the parking brake, and switch off.
10. Remove the key when leaving the tractor unattended and report defects promptly.

⚠ Safety

- Never carry passengers unless the tractor is specifically designed and approved for them.
- Use the seat belt with the rollover protective structure where fitted.
- Keep clear of rotating power take-off shafts and other moving components.
- Avoid steep slopes, sharp turns at speed, and sudden braking with a raised load.
- Never start or service the tractor from beneath an unsupported raised implement.
- Refuel only with the engine stopped and away from flames or sparks.

Care & storage

- Clean mud and crop residue from the tractor after safe shutdown.
- Inspect tyres, brakes, hitch points, belts, hoses, and guards regularly.
- Follow the manual for engine servicing, lubrication, filters, and fluid changes.
- Arrange authorised repair for leaks, brake faults, warning lights, or unusual vibration.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Driving without checking brakes, steering, tyres, and attached implements.
- Carrying passengers on a tractor not designed for passengers.
- Approaching a rotating power take-off shaft while it is running.
- Leaving the tractor running or implements raised while unattended.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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